

Beginly.app

v1.2 Re-Evaluation Report

Using the live website, Beginly codebase, and NewStart UK Documentation Pack v1.2 as source-of-truth context

Executive classification

Beginly is a strong public-brand evolution of the NewStart UK v1.2 architecture, but the current live site/codebase remains an alpha-to-MVP bridge - not yet a 10/10 production MVP.

Prepared for product, design, engineering, trust/compliance, and MVP stabilisation planning

1. Executive Verdict

Beginly is now a stronger product direction than NewStart UK as a public brand. It is short, ownable, app-native, and better aligned with the secured Beginly.app domain. However, the current implementation is best treated as Beginly v1.2 Alpha / Early MVP Foundation, not a finished 10/10 MVP.

Main judgement

Good progress. Stronger brand. Better product surface. Not yet 10/10. Needs stabilisation before further feature expansion.

2. Scorecard

Area	Current Status	Score
Public brand/domain direction	Strong	8.5/10
Landing page messaging	Strong	8/10
Visual/UI direction	Improved, still inconsistent	7/10
Content library	Stronger	8/10
Compliance language	Good on public pages, uneven in Nia/helpers	7/10
Auth flow	Partially implemented, not clean	4/10
Onboarding to dashboard flow	At risk	4/10
Personalised roadmap logic	Still weak	5/10
Supabase/database readiness	Draft, not production-safe	4/10
Admin functionality	Preview only	4/10
Document Helper	Good idea, overclaims upload capability	5/10
Production readiness	Not ready	3/10

Summary: Brand/product concept is approximately 8/10, functional MVP is approximately 5.5/10, and production readiness is approximately 3/10.

3. Source-of-Truth Baseline

Beginly should be understood as the public-facing brand evolution of the NewStart UK v1.2 product architecture, not as a separate unrelated product. The original v1.2 pack defined MVP v1 as a student-first UK newcomer settlement platform with authentication, onboarding profile, personalised roadmap, checklist dashboard, task details, guidance library, scam alerts, reminders, basic admin, and Document Helper Lite.

The core operating rule remains: do not let growth override trust; do not let AI override compliance; do not let design override clarity; do not let B2B promises exceed the MVP.

4. Live Website Evaluation

What the live site does well

- The homepage clearly communicates a UK settlement journey proposition.
- The public promise around a personalised 90-day checklist, plain-English guidance, scam alerts, Document Helper, Nia, and official source signposting is directionally correct.
- The signup page is clean and direct, with name, email, password, confirm password, and visible disclaimer language.
- The guidance library has useful categories: documents, accommodation, money, health, university, work, safety, local life, local admin, growth, and transport.

Live site issues

- **Authenticated-style navigation appears publicly:** public pages such as guides show dashboard-style menus and sign-out links, creating UX confusion.
- **Document Helper overpromises:** the live page offers PDF, PNG, JPG, or TXT upload, but the implementation does not truly parse/analyse PDFs or images.
- **“Free forever” needs care:** this may conflict with future commercial routes. Safer public wording is “Free to start” or “Core roadmap access is free during MVP.”

5. Codebase Evaluation

Meaningful improvements

- The codebase now includes package-lock.json, next-env.d.ts, auth API routes, middleware, Supabase client, Supabase schema draft, tests setup, richer routes, Nia component, guidance articles, scam alerts, dashboard/checklist/task pages, admin routes, support page, settings page, sitemap, robots file, favicon, and design system documentation.
- The project is no longer just a static checklist prototype; it is now a proper product shell.
- The content layer has improved and outdated BRP/police-registration assumptions are no longer treated as the active default product path.

6. Critical Blocker: Split Auth System

The most important technical issue is that the app currently has two competing sources of truth. Signup/login use server/API routes and cookies, while dashboard, onboarding, checklist, reminders, support, settings, and navigation still depend heavily on localStorage helpers.

Impact

After signup, the API may set a cookie and redirect to onboarding, but onboarding may check localStorage and redirect back to signup. This can break the core signup -> onboarding -> dashboard journey.

Required fix

- Use Supabase/session-backed user state as the authority.
- /api/user should become the source of truth for authenticated user/profile state.
- Authenticated pages should fetch user/profile data from API or server session, not localStorage.
- LocalStorage should only be temporary cache or UI preference storage.

7. Admin Security

Admin access is not yet acceptable. Middleware checks an admin cookie and the sidebar checks a localStorage admin flag. Both patterns can be spoofed from the browser.

- Verify admin role from a signed session token or database role on the server.
- Remove client-controlled admin localStorage checks.
- Protect /admin, /admin/tasks, and /admin/guides through server-verified roles.
- Stop relying on editable cookies such as nsk_is_admin or client-set flags.

8. Supabase Schema Readiness

The Supabase schema shows good intent, but it remains draft-level rather than production-safe.

Issue	Risk
Invalid SQL comments	The schema uses # comments; Postgres expects -- comments.
Unsafe RLS policies	Policies using true or OR true defeat Row Level Security.
Frontend/DB mismatch	arrivalStatus, arrivalDate, accommodationType, interestedInWork do not map cleanly to status, arrival_date, accommodation, work_interest.
Task status mismatch	Frontend uses not_started/in_progress/complete while DB defaults to pending.

A proper adapter layer is required: frontendProfileToDb, dbProfileToFrontend, frontendTaskToDb, and dbTaskToFrontend. The schema also needs safe RLS, constraints, support ticket storage, guidance/content storage, admin audit logs, reminders, and source review records.

9. Tailwind and Design System Wiring

The design system is strong, but it is not fully wired into the code. The code uses classes such as bg-background, bg-primary, text-civic-700, bg-violet-light, text-violet, and border-border, but the Tailwind config does not fully define these classes.

- Update tailwind.config.ts with proper theme colour mappings from CSS variables.
- Remove the misleading comment that says the real theme lives in tailwind.config.js if no such file exists.
- Apply the Beginly v2 design tokens consistently across pages and components.
- Replace remaining placeholder branding with the approved Beginly identity.

10. Beginly Rebrand Cleanup

The rebrand is visible publicly, but old NewStart and nsk references remain in code, docs, cookies, localStorage keys, email examples, and developer prompts.

Old	New
NewStart UK	Beginly
Nia - The NewStart Navigator	Nia - The Beginly Navigator
newstartuk.app	beginly.app
noreply@newstartuk.app	noreply@beginly.app
nsk_session	beginly_session
nsk_user / nsk_profile / nsk_tasks	beginly_user / beginly_profile / beginly_tasks

NewStart UK should remain only as internal project lineage, not as user-facing naming.

11. Personalised Roadmap and Checklist Logic

The checklist still appears closer to all tasks plus filters than a truly personalised roadmap. The v1.2 architecture requires task visibility by condition, dependencies, reminder triggers, readiness scoring, guidance links, risk warnings, source review, AI helper allowance, escalation flag, and admin editability.

Required generator behaviour

- Private-rental tasks should show only for private_rental accommodation profiles.
- Work/NI tasks should show only if interestedInWork is true, or be clearly optional.
- Not-secured accommodation should trigger accommodation-search and scam-safety tasks.
- Arrival stage should prioritise PRE, D1, D7, and D30 tasks appropriately.
- Dependencies should block or de-emphasise dependent tasks until prerequisites are completed.
- Generated tasks should be stored against the authenticated user.

12. Onboarding Date Logic Bug

The onboarding date field appears to restrict users to dates up to today, but users who are arriving soon need to select a future date.

- If arrivalStatus is not_arrived or arriving_soon, allow future dates.
- If arrivalStatus is arrived, restrict date to today or earlier.
- If no date is given, fall back to arrivalStatus.
- If arrivalStatus and date conflict, show a warning before continuing.

13. Nia and Document Helper Guardrails

Nia is present and directionally correct, but guardrails need to be stricter. The original product boundary is that AI can simplify, explain, draft, and signpost, but must not decide, guarantee, diagnose, represent, or submit sensitive official actions.

Nia improvements needed

- Remove financial product rankings and “top account” style recommendations.

- Soften definitive health, visa, work, and housing claims.
- Signpost official sources and qualified professionals for sensitive matters.
- Add tests for sensitive-topic responses and refusal patterns.

Document Helper MVP rule

Privacy-safe MVP recommendation

Make Document Helper paste-text-only for MVP. Remove PDF/image upload or mark upload support as coming soon until real extraction, consent, retention, and privacy controls are implemented.

14. Support, Settings, and Operational Gaps

- **Support form:** currently local-only in code. If the page says Beginly will reply, submissions must persist to Supabase or send an email notification.
- **Settings/delete copy:** must not promise 14-day reversal or complete server deletion if only local browser data is cleared.
- **Admin dashboard:** exists as a preview, but must persist edits and enforce role-based access before it counts as MVP admin functionality.
- **Reminders:** should move from plan/preview into saved reminder records and Resend-backed email workflow.

15. Website vs Code Consistency

Area	Website	Code Reality
Personalised roadmap	Promised strongly	Logic still mostly seed-task/filter based
Document upload	Offered publicly	Not truly parsed/analyzed
Support	Promises reply	Local-only in code
Official source review	Reassuring copy	Source system not fully operational
Auth	Visible	Server/client state split
Admin	Exists in code	Not safely role-protected/persistent
Free forever	Public claim	Commercial model may evolve

16. Recommended Next Sprint: Beginly v1.2 Stabilisation Sprint

The next sprint should focus on stabilisation, not new features or more pages.

1. Make auth and data coherent

- Use Supabase/session as the source of truth.
- Fix signup -> onboarding -> dashboard.
- Save profile, generated tasks, support tickets, and reminder preferences to the database.

2. Secure admin

- Remove client-controlled admin flags.
- Verify admin from signed session or database role.
- Protect admin routes server-side.

3. Fix Supabase schema

- Replace invalid SQL comments.
- Remove unsafe RLS policies.
- Align frontend and database field names.
- Add missing production tables and constraints.

4. Complete Beginly migration

- Replace all NewStart-facing docs/copy.
- Rename nsk_* keys/cookies.
- Update env examples and developer prompts.

5. Implement real task personalisation

- Generate tasks from profile conditions.
- Use stage-aware prioritisation and dependency blocking.
- Clean up stale generated tasks after profile changes.

6. Tighten Document Helper and Nia

- Make helper paste-text-only for MVP.
- Remove risky recommendations.
- Add guardrail tests.

7. Wire design system

- Fix Tailwind config.
- Apply Beginly tokens.
- Replace placeholder logo with approved icon.

17. Final Verdict

Final re-evaluation

Beginly is a good alpha and a credible MVP foundation. It should not be expanded further until the stabilisation sprint is completed.

The project is close enough that one focused stabilisation sprint could move it from promising alpha to real MVP candidate. The biggest blockers are auth/data coherence, admin security, Supabase schema safety, profile-led task generation, design-system wiring, Document Helper privacy alignment, and final Beginly rebrand cleanup.

Recommended developer instruction: Stop adding new pages. Fix auth, data persistence, security, Tailwind/design-system mapping, Beginly rebrand cleanup, and profile-led task generation first.

Appendix: Source Context Used

- Live website: beginly.app public routes reviewed from the user-provided domain context.
- Codebase: Beginly-main.zip earlier shared in the conversation.
- Product baseline: NewStart UK Documentation Pack v1.2, including Delivery Note and Complete Master Pack.
- Design baseline: NewStartUK Design System v2.0 and design board explorations.